new step for signing the release candidate. For example, we could use Sigstore (www.sigstore.dev), a non-profit service that provides open source tools for signing, verifying, and protecting software integrity. If you're interested in this subject, I recommend visiting the project's website.

In the following section, I'll show you how to implement the new steps in the commit stage of our deployment pipeline.

6.4.2 Publishing container images with GitHub Actions

GitHub Actions is an engine that you can use to automate software workflows directly from your GitHub repositories. Workflow definitions are conventionally stored in a .github/workflows directory placed in the root of a repository on GitHub.

In chapter 3, we started developing a workflow to implement the commit stage of the deployment pipeline for Catalog Service. Let's now continue the implementation by adding further steps to package and publish the application.

From your Catalog Service project (catalog-service), open the workflow definition for the commit stage (.github/workflows/commit-stage.yml) and define a few environment variables to store some essential facts you'll need when building a container image for the application. By using environment variables, you can easily change which container registry you use or the version for the release artifact. Remember to add your GitHub username, all in lowercase, instead of the placeholder in the following listing. Chapter 15 will cover software release strategies, but until then we're going to tag every image with `latest` instead of a version number.